



Sure Access to Success

DIRECT – INDIRECT RULES

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Direct Speech

- **When the exact words of the speaker are quoted.**
- *Structure:*
- [Speaker] + says/said + “exact words”
- *Example:*
- He said, “I am going to the market.”

Indirect (Reported) Speech

- When the words of the speaker are reported without quoting exactly, often changing pronouns, tenses, and words like "this" or "now".
- *Structure:*
- [Speaker] + said/told + that + reported sentence
- *Example:*
- He said that he was going to the market.

Basic Rules for Changing Direct to Indirect Speech

- Step 1: Remove quotation marks
- Step 2: Change pronouns appropriately
- Step 3: Change tenses (in most cases)
- Step 4: Change time/place words
- Step 5: Use "that" for statements, "if/whether" for yes-no questions, and question words for wh-questions

John said, “I am going to the market now.”
John said that he was going to the market then.

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- **Step 2: Change pronouns appropriately**

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- **Step 5: Use "that" for statements, "if/whether" for yes-no questions, and question words for wh-questions**

Tense Change Rules

If the reporting verb is in the past tense (said, told, etc.), the tense of the reported speech usually changes as follows:

• DIRECT SPEECH	INDIRECT SPEECH
• Present Simple →	Past Simple
• Present Continuous →	Past Continuous
• Present Perfect →	Past Perfect
• Past Simple →	Past Perfect
• Past Continuous →	Past Perfect Continuous
• Will/shall →	Would/should
• Can/may →	Could/might

Tense Change Rules

If the reporting verb is in the past tense (said, told, etc.), the tense of the reported speech usually changes as follows:

DIRECT SPEECH

Present Simple →

He said, "I **play** football." →

INDIRECT SPEECH

Past Simple

He said that he **played** football.

Tense Change Rules

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DIRECT SPEECH

Present Continuous →

INDIRECT SPEECH

Past Continuous

She said, “I **am reading** a book.” → She said that she **was reading** a book.

Tense Change Rules

If the reporting verb is in the past tense (said, told, etc.), the tense of the reported speech usually changes as follows:

DIRECT SPEECH

Present Perfect →

They said, "We **have left**." →

INDIRECT SPEECH

Past Perfect

They said that they **had left**.

Tense Change Rules

If the reporting verb is in the past tense (said, told, etc.), the tense of the reported speech usually changes as follows:

DIRECT SPEECH

Past Simple →

He said, "I **went** to Delhi." →

INDIRECT SPEECH

Past Perfect

He said that he **had gone** to Delhi.

Tense Change Rules

If the reporting verb is in the past tense (said, told, etc.), the tense of the reported speech usually changes as follows:

DIRECT SPEECH

Past Continuous →

- He said, 'I **have been consulting** them.' → He said that he **had been consulting** them.

INDIRECT SPEECH

Past Perfect Continuous

Tense Change Rules

If the reporting verb is in the past tense (said, told, etc.), the tense of the reported speech usually changes as follows:

DIRECT SPEECH

Will/shall →

She said, “I **will help** you.” →

INDIRECT SPEECH

Would/should

She said that she **would help** me.

Tense Change Rules

If the reporting verb is in the past tense (said, told, etc.), the tense of the reported speech usually changes as follows:

DIRECT SPEECH

Can/may →

He said, "I **can** help her." →

INDIRECT SPEECH

Could/might

He said that he **could** help her.

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Changes of Time Words

• DIRECT SPEECH

- Now
- Today
- Tomorrow
- Yesterday
- Ago

INDIRECT SPEECH

Then

That day

The next day / The following day

The previous day / The day before

Before

Changes of Time Words

• DIRECT SPEECH

- Now
- Today
- Tomorrow
- Yesterday
- Ago

INDIRECT SPEECH

Then
That day
The next day / The following day
The previous day / The day before
Before

He said, "I will call you **tomorrow**."

→ He said that he would call me the **next day**.

She said, "I met him **yesterday**."

→ She said that she had met him **the day before**.

Changes of Place Words

- **DIRECT SPEECH**

- This
- These
- Here

- **INDIRECT SPEECH**

That
Those
There

Changes of Place Words

• DIRECT SPEECH

- This
- These
- Here

INDIRECT SPEECH

That
Those
There

They said, “We are **here now**.”

→ They said that they were **there then**.

John said, ‘I don’t want **this** pen instead of **these** pencils.’

→ John said that he did not want **that** pen instead of **those** pencils.

How to Change Questions

Yes/No Questions (starting with Auxiliaries)

Use **if** or **whether**

He said, “Are you coming?” → He asked **if** I was coming.

How to Change Questions

Wh-Questions

Keep the question word, change structure to statement form.

She asked, “**Where** do you live?”

→ She asked **where** I lived.

How to Change Questions

Examples

He asked, "Do you like pizza?"

He asked if I liked pizza.

She asked, "Where are you going?"

She asked where I was going.

They said, "Is it raining?"

They asked if it was raining.

How to Change Questions

Examples

They **said**, “Is it raining?”

They **asked** if it was raining.

How to Change Commands, Requests, and Exclamations

Commands/Orders

Use told or ordered + to-infinitive

He said, "Sit down." →

He told me to sit down.

How to Change Commands, Requests, and Exclamations

Negative Commands

Use not + to-infinitive

He said, “Don’t go there.” →

He told me not to go there.

How to Change Commands, Requests, and Exclamations

Exclamations

Express with words like exclaimed, wished, prayed, etc.

She said, “**Wow!** What a beautiful house!” →

She **exclaimed** that it was a beautiful house.

Exceptions Where Tense Does Not Change

- If the reporting verb is in present/future tense
- If the reported speech expresses a universal truth or fact

Exceptions Where Tense Does Not Change

- If the reporting verb is in present/future tense

He **says**, "I like coffee." →

He **says** that he likes coffee.

Exceptions Where Tense Does Not Change

- If the reported speech expresses a universal truth or fact.
- The teacher said, “The sun **rises** in the east.” →
- The teacher said that the sun **rises** in the east.

How to Change Indirect Speech to Direct Speech?

Reverse the process:

- Remove "that," "if," or "whether"
- Restore the original tense
- Change pronouns back to original form
- Replace time/place words accordingly
- Add quotation marks

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Reverse the process:

- Remove "that," "if," or "whether"
- Restore the original tense
- Change pronouns back to original form
- Replace time/place words accordingly
- Add quotation marks
- **Indirect: He said that he was hungry.**
- **Direct: He said, "I am hungry."**
- **Indirect: She asked if I was busy.**
- **Direct: She asked, "Are you busy?"**
- **Indirect: They said that they would come the next day.**
- **Direct: They said, "We will come tomorrow."**

Summary

• TYPE	DIRECT SPEECH EXAMPLE	INDIRECT SPEECH EXAMPLE
• Statement	He said, "I am tired."	He said that he was tired.
• Yes/No Qs	She asked, "Are you okay?"	She asked if I was okay.
• Wh-Question	He asked, "Where is she?"	He asked where she was.
• Command	She said, "Close the door."	She told me to close the door.
• - Ve Command	He said, "Don't shout."	He told me not to shout.
• Request	She said, "Please help me."	She requested me to help her.
• Exclamation	He said, "What a day!"	He exclaimed that it was a terrible day.

Quick Tips

- Always check the tense of the reporting verb first.
- Pronouns change based on speaker and listener.
- Time/place words change based on context.
- Structure of questions changes to statements in reported speech.
- Don't change tense for universal truths